

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's *Reflections on:* **PRAYER,** **PROCLAMATION and** **PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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Theme: COMPASSION – (Love in Action)

► **The act of expressing love in practical ways!**

The word **Compassion** - Originating from the Latin *compati*, *compassion* means to see the suffering of others and take action to stop it.

Biblical dictionary

Compassion that (human) disposition that fuels *Acts of kindness* and *mercy*.

Compassion, a form of love, is aroused within us when we are confronted with those who suffer or are vulnerable.

Compassion can be defined as a feeling of *deep sympathy and sorrow* for another who is stricken by misfortune, accompanied by a strong desire to alleviate the suffering. Thus, emotionally and attitudinally, *compassion* presupposes sympathy/empathy/understanding/pity.

1. THE COMPASSIONATE GOD

GOD is full of compassion

Psalms 86:15 But thou, O Lord, art a God full of compassion, and gracious; long-suffering, and abundant in mercy and truth. Webster

Psalms 86:15 But you, O Lord, are a God of compassion and mercy, slow to get angry and filled with unfailing love and faithfulness. NLT

Psalms 145:8 The LORD is gracious and full of compassion, Slow to anger and great in mercy. NKJV

Psalms 103:8 The Lord is compassionate and gracious, slow to anger, abounding in love. NIV

Psalms 111:4 He has caused His wonderful works to be remembered. The Lord is gracious and compassionate. Holman C.B.

GOD DECIDES who he shows compassion on

Romans 9:15 For he saith to Moses, I will have mercy on whom I will have mercy, and I will have compassion on whom I will have compassion. Webster

Hebrews 10:34 for you had compassion on me in my chains, and joyfully accepted the plundering of your goods, knowing that you have a better and an enduring possession for yourselves in heaven. NKJV

2. THE COMPASSIONATE CHRIST

JESUS had compassion on the two blind men.

Matthew 20:29 So Jesus had compassion on them, and touched their eyes: and immediately their eyes received sight, and they followed him. Webster

JESUS was moved with compassion on the leper

Mark 1:41 And Jesus, moved with compassion, put forth his hand, and touched him, and saith to him, I will; be thou clean. KJV

JESUS had compassion on the multitudes

Mark 8:2 I have compassion on the multitude, because they have now been with me three days, and have nothing to eat: KJV

JESUS'S compassion in healing the sick

Matthew 14:14 When Jesus landed and saw a large crowd, he had compassion on them and healed their sick. NIV

HIS compassion healing the DEMONIAK

Mark 5:18-19

18 And when He got into the boat, he who had been demon-possessed begged Him that he might be with Him.

19 Jesus said "Go home to your friends, and tell them what great things the Lord has done for you, and how He has had compassion on you." NKJV

OUR HIGH PRIEST JESUS shows compassion on the ignorant

Hebrews 5:2 Who can have compassion on the ignorant, and on them that are out of the way; for that he himself also is compassed with infirmity. Webster

3. COMPASSIONATE PEOPLE in scripture

PHAROAHS DAUGHTER had compassion on baby Moses

Exodus 2:6 And when she had opened it, she saw the child: and behold, the babe wept. And she had compassion on him, and said, This is one of the Hebrews' children. Webster

★ This daughter's act of compassion in bringing Moses to be brought up in the palace changed the whole course and future destiny of Israel.

THE SAMARITAN showed compassion

Luke 10:33 But a certain Samaritan, as he journeyed, came where he was: and when he saw him, he had compassion on him, Webster

A MOTHER'S compassion for her child

Isaiah 49:15 Can a woman forget her sucking child, that she should not have compassion on the son of her womb? yes, they may forget, yet I will not forget thee. Webster

★ Imagine the intense persistent unwavering passion of a mother for one of her children.

4. THE COMPASSIONATE CHRISTIAN

BOWELS of compassion

1 John 3:17 But he who hath this world's good, and seeth his brother have need, and shutteth up his bowels of compassion from him, how dwelleth the love of God in him? Webster

★ Compassion is the heartfelt response of empathy and care for the suffering and needs of others. The Bible consistently emphasizes the importance of compassion and portrays it as an essential virtue for believers to embody in their interactions with one another and the world around them.

A MASTER showed compassion to his servant

Matthew 18:27 Then the master of that servant was moved with compassion, released him, and forgave him the debt. NKJV

1 Peter 3:8 Finally, all of you be of one mind, having compassion for one another; love as brothers, be tenderhearted, be courteous; NKJV

Ephesians 4:32 Be kind and compassionate to one another, forgiving each other, just as in Christ God forgave you. NIV

HAVING COMPASSION makes the difference

Jude 1:22 And of some have compassion, making a difference: Webster

5. A COMPASSIONATE EARTHLY FATHER

Luke 15:20 So he got up and went to his father. "But while he was still a long way off, his father saw him and was filled with compassion for him; he ran to his son, threw his arms around him and kissed him. NIV

Luke 11:11-13

11 What father among you, if his son asks for a fish, will give him a snake instead of a fish?

12 Or if he asks for an egg, will give him a scorpion?

13 If you then, who are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will the heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit to those who ask Him?" Holman

2 Samuel 18:33

33 The king was overcome with emotion. He went up to the room over the gateway and burst into tears. And as he went, he cried, "O my son Absalom! My son, my son Absalom! If only I had died instead of you! O Absalom, my son, my son." NLT

► **COMPASSION IS THE COMPELLING FORCE IN THE HEART (of God or a person) THAT MOTIVATES THEM INTO POSITIVE ACTION.**

► **Note: - IF WE WANT TO KEEP ON GOING TOWARDS SUFFERING AND NEEDY PEOPLE (like the good Samaritan) THEN IT WILL REQUIRE COMPASSION.**

► **AND THIS MEANS MAINTAINING THE COMPASSION FACTOR IN OUR LIVES AT ALL TIMES.**

► **WITHOUT COMPASSION WE WILL LOSE OUR MOTIVATION!**

AMEN – Ps Barry